

CLAT Express - May 2026: Answer Key

Multiple-choice passages

UAE Visit Outcomes Check

1	D. Mohammed bin Rashid Al Maktoum	The booklet lists Mohammed bin Rashid Al Maktoum as Prime Minister, while Mohammed bin Zayed Al Nahyan is listed as President.
2	D. Al Maktoum International Airport	The booklet names Al Maktoum International Airport in Jebel Ali, Dubai, as the world's largest airport terminal.
3	B. Only two	Statement III is wrong because the booklet places Al Maktoum International Airport in Jebel Ali, Dubai, while statements I and II match the booklet.
4	D. 30 million barrels	The booklet states India proposed storing up to 30 million barrels of ADNOC crude oil in its Strategic Petroleum Reserves.
5	B. Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A	The booklet states both facts, but the remittance share does not explain the UAE's place in India's Strategic Reserve Programme.
6	D. I and III only	Statement II is wrong because the booklet ranks the UAE as India's 3rd largest crude oil source, while statements I and III match the booklet.
7	D. Zayed Talwar	The booklet lists Zayed Talwar as the naval component, with Desert Cyclone as the military exercise and Desert Eagle as the air force exercise.
8	A. I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B	The booklet gives US\$100 billion for trade, 18% for the remittance share, up to US\$1 billion for investment and 30 million barrels for the proposed storage.

OPEC and the UAE Exit: MCQ Set

1	A. Vienna, Austria	The booklet gives OPEC's headquarters as Vienna, Austria.
2	D. Baghdad Conference	The booklet states OPEC was established at the Baghdad Conference in 1960.
3	B. Only two	Statements I and II are stated in the booklet, while the claim that Ecuador rejoined in 1992 is wrong.
4	A. UAE	The booklet lists the founders as Iran, Iraq, Kuwait, Saudi Arabia and Venezuela, and says the UAE joined in 1967.
5	A. Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A	The booklet says the UAE is a major oil producer, and its exit reduces the group's collective discipline over prices.
6	C. I and II only	Statements I and II match the booklet, while Russia was the 3rd-largest oil producer in 2022, so III is wrong.
7	D. I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A	Peak Oil Theory is linked to M. King Hubbert, OFID to 1976, OPEC+ to 2016, and the pipeline connects Habshan to Fujairah.
8	A. Gabon	The booklet says Gabon terminated its membership in January 1995, while Ecuador was only suspended in 1992.

Panel recommendations check

1	D. Ten	The panel recommended creating 10 new posts related to administration, IT infrastructure and digital security.
2	C. I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A	Governance reforms match the governing body, restructuring matches the 10 new posts, the Digi-Exam framework matches the authentication system, and the online shift matches Computer Adaptive Testing.

3	B. I and III only	The governing body with sub-committees and the gradual CAT proposal are recommended, while private coaching institutes are not mentioned as centres.
4	C. Only three	Statements I to III match the recommendations, while the panel said the NTA should not conduct recruitment examinations, so statement IV is wrong.
5	D. Three	The sub-committees are for Test Audits, Ethics and Transparency, and Staff Management and Appointments.
6	A. Higher education institutions	The panel said the NTA should focus only on entrance examinations for higher education institutions.
7	D. Digi-Yatra	The booklet describes the authentication system as similar to Digi-Yatra.

Court ruling: legal reasoning

1	C. Section 4(3)	Section 4(3) excludes ancient monuments under the AMASR Act, 1958 from the religious character freeze provision.
2	C. April 1937	The bench noted that the Government of India Act, 1935 was not enforced until April 1937.
3	D. Article 226	The case was treated as a Writ Petition under Article 226 seeking enforcement of the fundamental right to worship.
4	C. I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C	Section 3 prohibits conversion, Section 4(1) freezes religious identity, Section 5 exempts ancient monuments and Section 6 sets penalties.
5	B. Only two	Statements A and D are correct; B is wrong because the Babri Masjid dispute was a title suit, and C is wrong because the bench rejected the proclamation.
6	D. P V Narasimha Rao-led Congress government	The Act was passed by the P V Narasimha Rao-led Congress government.

Expansion of the Supreme Court Bench

1	D. 38	The Bill expands the Court to 38 judges, which is the CJI plus 37 other judges.
2	A. Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A	Article 124 is the constitutional provision that empowers Parliament to change the Court's strength by law.
3	C. I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A	Soumitra Sen was impeached in Rajya Sabha and resigned, Ramaswami's motion failed when Lok Sabha abstained, Nagarjuna's failed for lack of signatures, and Dinakaran resigned before impeachment.
4	A. I and II only	Statements I and II match the text, while removal is on the recommendation of Parliament, not the Union Cabinet.
5	B. Only two	Statements II and III are correct, while the Court was inaugurated on 28 January 1950 and its advisory opinion is not binding on the President.
6	C. President of India	Article 127 requires consultation with the Chief Justice of the High Court concerned and the previous consent of the President.
7	C. Part 5	The text places Articles 124 to 147 in Part 5 of the Constitution.
8	D. HR Khanna	AN Ray was appointed by superseding JM Shelat, KS Hegde and AN Grover, while HR Khanna was superseded in 1977.

Mergers, Exceptions and Member Categories

1	C. 10th Schedule	The booklet states that the Anti-Defection Law is enshrined in the 10th Schedule of the Constitution.
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2	C. A is true but R is false	Independent members are disqualified for joining a party after election, so A is true and R is false.
3	B. I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C	The 52nd Amendment introduced the law, the 91st Amendment removed the split provision, and the Keisham ruling ideally sets 3 months.
4	C. I and II only	Statement III is wrong because the 91st Amendment removed the split provision, so only statements I and II are correct.
5	A. Only two	Statement II is wrong because the ideal timeframe is 3 months, so statements I and III are correct.
6	D. Articles 102(1) and 191(1)	The booklet states that a legislator can be disqualified on general grounds under Articles 102(1) and 191(1).
7	A. It restricts members from voting independently and expressing dissent in the legislature	The booklet lists curtailment of legislative freedom as a key issue because the law restricts MPs and MLAs from voting independently.
8	B. If prior permission is taken or the party condones the action within 15 days	Prior permission, or condonation by the party within 15 days, is the exception to disqualification for voting against the whip.

Reserves Under Pressure

1	A. 2nd largest	The booklet describes India as the 2nd largest gold consumer globally, after China.
2	D. About 89%	The booklet states that India imports around 89% of its crude oil requirement.
3	B. Domestic government securities	The booklet lists foreign currency assets, gold reserves, Special Drawing Rights and the reserve position with the IMF as components.
4	C. Import restrictions increase input costs, reducing export competitiveness	The booklet says import restrictions increase input costs, thereby reducing the competitiveness of exports.
5	C. A is true but R is false	Household gold imports directly worsen the CAD, but the booklet says they do not add to productive capacity, unlike sovereign reserves.
6	A. I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B	India is the 2nd largest gold consumer, imports about 89% of crude oil, gold is about 9% of imports, and each USD 1 oil rise adds USD 1.5 to 2 billion to the import bill.
7	C. I and III only	Statement II is wrong because private consumption is a major GDP component, while statements I and III reflect the booklet's points.
8	B. Only two	Statements I and II match the booklet, while III reverses its point that foreign investors avoid economies lacking strong domestic demand.

Rankings and Key Findings 2026

1	C. Ten	The booklet states Norway was top-ranked for the 10th consecutive year.
2	B. 92.72	The booklet lists Norway with a score of 92.72 among the highest ranked.
3	C. 52.2 per cent	The booklet states that 52.2 per cent of countries face Difficult or Very Serious conditions.
4	A. Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A	The booklet links the decline in press freedom to the majority of countries (52.2%) facing Difficult or Very Serious conditions.

5	B. I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C	Syria had the sharpest rise, Niger the steepest fall, India ranked 157th with 31.96, and Netherlands scored 88.92.
6	D. I and II only	Syria registered the sharpest rise in rankings after its political transition, so statement III is incorrect.
7	A. Only one	The index covers 180 countries, and India ranked 157th in 2026 (151st was its 2025 rank), so only statement II is correct.
8	B. Netherlands	The top-ranked order given is Norway, Netherlands, Estonia, Denmark, Sweden.

LEADS basics check

1	B. I and III only	Statement I and statement III are correct, while LEADS was launched in 2018, not 2015.
2	B. Only two	Statements 1 and 3 are correct, while statement 2 gives the wrong launch year and statement 4 names the wrong ministry.
3	C. 2018	The booklet states that LEADS was launched in 2018.
4	D. 13	The LEADS 2025 Report is presented across 13 logistics-related categories.
5	B. Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A	Both statements are true, but the two-year reporting cycle does not explain why LEADS draws inspiration from the index.
6	A. Logistics Excellence, Advancement and Performance Shield	LEAPS stands for Logistics Excellence, Advancement and Performance Shield.
7	A. PM GatiShakti and National Logistics Policy 2022	The booklet says the initiatives support PM GatiShakti and the National Logistics Policy 2022.

Pokhran and the 1998 milestones

1	B. Smiling Buddha	Pokhran-I, India's first nuclear test, was codenamed 'Smiling Buddha'.
2	C. Three	Pokhran-II began on 11 May 1998 with three nuclear tests under the codename Shakti.
3	A. Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A	The booklet states that Pokhran-II (Operation Shakti) marked India's emergence as a nuclear weapons state.
4	A. I and II only	Statement III is wrong because Pokhran-I was conducted on 18 May 1974, and Operation Shakti refers to the 1998 tests.
5	B. Only two	Only two nuclear tests were conducted on 13 May 1998, so statement II is wrong while statements I and III are correct.
6	B. Abdul Kalam and R. Chidambaram	The booklet names Abdul Kalam and R. Chidambaram as the chief coordinators of Pokhran-II.
7	C. 6th	The booklet states that India became the 6th country to join the nuclear club.

Constitution and labour laws: practice set

1	A. Article 24	The booklet states that Article 24 prohibits employment of children below 14 years.
2	D. Article 43	The booklet states that Article 43 orders the State to secure a living wage, decent conditions of work and social and cultural opportunities.
3	B. I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B	Article 19(1)(c) grants the right to form associations or unions, Article 39(a) gives the equal right to a means of livelihood, Article 43A covers worker participation and Article 41 covers work and education.

4	A. I and III only	Article 24, not Article 19(1)(c), prohibits employment of children below 14 years, so statement II is incorrect.
5	C. Only three	The booklet dates the Payment of Wages Act to 1936, so statement II is incorrect while the other three are correct.
6	B. Occupational Safety, Health and Working Conditions Code	The chart lists 13 laws under the Occupational Safety, Health and Working Conditions Code, the highest count among the four codes.
7	D. 1970	The booklet lists the Contract Labour Act as dated 1970.

ASEAN Basics and Forums

1	B. 1994	The ARF was established in 1994 as a platform for political and security dialogue.
2	C. Jakarta, Indonesia	ASEAN is headquartered in Jakarta, Indonesia.
3	A. 2005	The EAS was created in 2005 as a leaders-level forum with a varied agenda.
4	D. 15 December 2008	The ASEAN Charter's effective date was 15 December 2008.
5	B. Both A and R are true but R does not explain A	Both statements are true, but the Charter's legal status does not explain the consensus-based decision-making process.
6	D. I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C	The ARF is a political and security dialogue platform, the Secretariat supports ASEAN's activities, the Coordinating Council oversees implementation, and the EAS is a leaders-level forum.
7	A. I and II only	The Charter took effect in 2008 and is legally binding, while AFTA was established in 1992, not 1967.
8	B. Only two	Statements I and III are correct, while the EAS was created in 2005 and the ARF was established in 1994.

Governance and Parliamentary Oversight

1	B. Front Runner (A)	Scores of 75-89 earn the Front Runner (A) grade under PAI 2.0.
2	D. Tripura	Tripura had the highest share of Front Runners, followed by Kerala and Odisha.
3	A. 22	The PAC has 22 members, 15 from the Lok Sabha and 7 from the Rajya Sabha.
4	C. A is true but R is false	The PAC examines spending only after it is incurred, but its recommendations are not binding, so only A is true.
5	A. I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B	ASUSE is conducted by MoSPI, the PAC was constituted in 1921, PAI 2.0 was released by the Ministry of Panchayati Raj and Karnataka won the most awards.
6	C. I and III only	Statements I and III are correct, while II is wrong because the Front Runner grade covers scores of 75-89.
7	B. Only two	Statements I and II are correct, while III and IV are wrong because ASUSE moved to a calendar year and the PAC was constituted in 1921.
8	D. Opposition party	The PAC Chairperson is chosen from an Opposition party by convention.

Global Cooperation Check

1	C. Ministry of External Affairs	The booklet states that SEEDS is implemented by the Ministry of External Affairs.
2	A. 2026	The booklet lists Bulgaria as a recent addition in 2026, while Croatia joined in 2023.

3	B. I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A	The Tea Act 1953 created the Tea Board, the ECB is headquartered in Frankfurt, the Eurozone has 21 members and SEEDS is run by the Ministry of External Affairs.
4	A. I and III only	Statement I matches the Article 24 mechanism and statement III matches the 1998 Maastricht Treaty entry, while Croatia joined in 2023 and Bulgaria in 2026.
5	D. Only two	Statements I and II are correct, while the Tea Board came from the Tea Act 1953 and the Eurozone has 21 members.
6	D. International Labour Organization	The booklet states that Article 24 belongs to the constitution of the International Labour Organization.
7	C. 1998	The booklet states that the Eurozone was established in 1998 under the Maastricht Treaty.

Type-in-the-answer passages

Nordic and Sweden Ties

1	43	The booklet states it was the first bilateral visit by an Indian PM to Norway in 43 years.
2	Oslo	The booklet says the 3rd India-Nordic Summit was held in Oslo, after the earlier summits in Stockholm (2018) and Copenhagen (2022).
3	Green Strategic Partnership	The booklet states India and Norway upgraded ties to a Green Strategic Partnership focused on clean energy and blue economy.
4	28	The booklet gives the Norwegian Sovereign Wealth Fund's investment in India as about USD 28 billion.
5	2019	The booklet states India and Sweden launched LeadIT at the UN Climate Action Summit in 2019.
6	2026-2030	The booklet states that both nations adopted the India-Sweden Joint Action Plan 2026-2030.
7	5	The booklet lists five core Nordic countries: Denmark, Finland, Iceland, Norway and Sweden.

Reasons and Impact: Short Answer Set

1	5	The booklet states the UAE aims to reach about 5 million barrels/day by 2027.
2	Fujairah	The booklet says the pipeline connects inland oil fields of Habshan to the port of Fujairah on the Gulf of Oman.
3	Saudi Arabia	The booklet lists long-standing tensions with Saudi Arabia over production policy within OPEC.
4	Rupees	The booklet says the shift supports India's de-dollarisation by encouraging energy settlements in rupees.
5	2016	The booklet states that OPEC+ was formed in 2016.
6	40	The booklet says OPEC+ pumps around 40% of the world's crude oil.
7	Ecuador	The booklet says Ecuador suspended its membership in 1992.

Public Examination Act check

1	3	Individuals face imprisonment ranging from 3 to 10 years depending on the offence.
2	4	Service providers face a fine up to 1 crore and debarment from conducting examinations for 4 years.

3	1	Monetary penalties up to 1 crore apply in cases involving organised malpractice.
4	5	Organised crimes attract imprisonment between 5 and 10 years and a minimum fine of 1 crore.
5	attachment and forfeiture	The Act lists the possibility of property attachment and forfeiture for organised crimes.
6	10	Individuals face imprisonment ranging from 3 to 10 years depending on the offence.
7	1	Service providers face a fine up to 1 crore along with debarment for 4 years.

Places of Worship Act: key details

1	1947	The Act ensures the religious identity of a place of worship remains as it was on August 15, 1947.
2	1958	The booklet dates the Ancient Monuments and Archaeological Sites and Remains Act to 1958.
3	6	Penalties for violating the Act are provided under Section 6.
4	4(2)	Section 4(2) terminates pre-1947 proceedings, with new cases allowed only for post-1947 changes.
5	P V Narasimha Rao	The Act was passed by the P V Narasimha Rao-led Congress government.
6	3	The booklet lists the prohibition on conversion of a place of worship under Section 3.

Appointment, Tenure and Removal Facts

1	65	A Supreme Court judge holds office until attaining the age of 65 years.
2	1968	The Judges Enquiry Act (1968) governs the removal procedure for SC and HC judges.
3	Soumitra Sen	Justice Soumitra Sen was impeached in Rajya Sabha but resigned before the Lok Sabha discussion.
4	1993	The Second Judges Case (1993) changed the meaning of consultation to concurrence.
5	4	The Third Judges Case (1998) requires the CJI to consult a collegium of 4 seniormost judges.
6	2	The NJAC composition includes 2 eminent persons from civil society nominated by the CJI, PM and Leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha.
7	MU Beg	MU Beg was appointed CJI in 1977, superseding HR Khanna.

Deciding Authority and Review

1	Speaker	The booklet states that the Speaker decides for the Lok Sabha, while the Chairman decides for the Rajya Sabha.
2	Chairman	The booklet names the Chairman of the Rajya Sabha as the deciding authority for its members.
3	two-thirds	The booklet states that no disqualification follows a merger if two-thirds of a legislature party agree.
4	3	The booklet states that the Keisham ruling says disqualification decisions should ideally be made within 3 months.
5	6	The booklet states that nominated members are disqualified if they join a party after 6 months of nomination.

6	Shrimanth Balasaheb Patil	The booklet lists the grounds for review, such as malafide intent and perverse decisions, in Shrimanth Balasaheb Patil vs Speaker Karnataka (2019).
7	Kihoto Hollohan	The booklet cites Kihoto Hollohan vs Zachillhu (1992) as the 1992 judgment on Speaker's decisions under the Tenth Schedule.

Import Pressure Check

1	89	The booklet states that India imports around 89% of its crude oil requirement.
2	China	The booklet describes India as the 2nd largest gold consumer globally, after China.
3	9	Gold accounts for nearly USD 72 billion, about 9% of total imports.
4	doubled	The booklet says prices of imported inputs such as urea and ammonia have doubled.
5	food security	The booklet says the government prioritises food security over discretionary fuel consumption.
6	fiscal deficit risk	The booklet says absorbing costs leads to fiscal deficit risk, while passing costs on carries inflation risk.
7	Liberalised Remittance Scheme	The booklet lists high outflows under the Liberalised Remittance Scheme, including spending on foreign travel and overseas weddings.

History of the Indian Press

1	1780	The booklet states India's first newspaper, Bengal Gazette, was published in 1780.
2	James Augustus Hickey	The booklet names James Augustus Hickey as the publisher of the Bengal Gazette.
3	Censorship of Press Act	The booklet states the Censorship of Press Act 1799 was issued by Lord Wellesley to curb French propaganda against British rule.
4	Metcalfe's Press Act	The booklet calls Metcalfe's Press Act 1835 the liberator of the Indian press.
5	1878	The booklet states the Vernacular Press Act of 1878 was enacted to suppress Indian press freedom.
6	1975	The booklet states the Press Council was abolished in 1975 during the Emergency after repeal of the 1965 Act.
7	Press Council Act 1978	The booklet states the Press Council was established in 1978 as a statutory quasi-judicial body under the Press Council Act 1978.

Freight corridor figures

1	DFCCIL	The Dedicated Freight Corridor Corporation of India (DFCCIL) is the implementing agency under the Ministry of Railways.
2	2030	The National Rail Plan aims for DFCs to boost rail freight's share to 45% by 2030.
3	10	The DFC objective is to reduce logistics costs below 10% as per the National Logistics Policy.
4	2022-23	The booklet cites DFCs' contribution to Indian Railways' revenue growth for FY 2018-19 to FY 2022-23.
5	Itarsi	The North-South DFC runs between Vijayawada and Itarsi.
6	975	The North-South DFC is listed as 975 km long.
7	1115	The East Coast DFC is listed as 1115 km long.

Space and defence firsts

1	Chandrayaan-1	Chandrayaan-1 (2008) was India's first lunar mission and discovered water on the Moon.
2	104	The 2017 launch of 104 satellites at once set a world record.
3	INS Vikrant	INS Vikrant (2022) is India's first indigenous aircraft carrier.
4	INS Kalvari	INS Kalvari (1967) was India's first indigenous submarine.
5	Gaganyaan	Gaganyaan (2027) is the upcoming first crewed spaceflight of India.
6	Aditya-L1	Aditya-L1 (2023) is India's first solar mission.

ILO: short answer set

1	1946	The booklet states that the ILO became the first specialised agency associated with the UN in 1946.
2	Gilbert Hougbo	The booklet names Gilbert Hougbo as the Director General of the ILO.
3	Geneva	The booklet gives the ILO headquarters as Geneva, Switzerland.
4	1969	The booklet notes that the ILO was awarded the Nobel Prize for Peace in 1969.
5	1998	The booklet records that the Declaration on Fundamental Principles and Rights at Work was adopted in 1998.
6	138	The booklet lists the Minimum Age convention as No. 138.
7	87	The booklet lists the Freedom of Association convention as No. 87.

RBI Surplus and Capital Framework

1	2019	The framework was introduced in 2019 following the Bimal Jalan Committee's recommendations.
2	Bimal Jalan	The RBI constituted a committee headed by Bimal Jalan to review the 2015-16 framework.
3	2013	The Malegam-led Technical Committee in 2013 recommended a higher transfer of reserves and surplus to the government.
4	47	Section 47 of the RBI Act, 1934 mandates that the RBI's profits from its operations be sent to the Centre.
5	5	The framework is reviewed every 5 years, and the 2025 review was one such exercise.
6	2012	The Contingency Risk Buffer forms the core of the RBI's Enterprise-Wide Risk Management Framework, introduced in 2012.
7	0.5	The surplus transfer to the government typically averages around 0.5% of GDP.

Methane, Solar Wind and Space Missions

1	MARS	MARS (Methane Alert and Response System) was launched at COP27 in 2022.
2	30	The Global Methane Pledge targets a 30% cut by 2030 against 2020 levels.
3	Chinese Academy of Sciences	The European Space Agency and the Chinese Academy of Sciences jointly launched SMILE.
4	French Guiana	SMILE was launched aboard a Vega-C rocket from French Guiana.
5	Link	SMILE is the Solar Wind Magnetosphere Ionosphere Link Explorer.

6	United States	China, the United States and India rank among the world's largest methane emitters.
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Environment and Weather Check

1	Palamu Tiger Reserve	The booklet states that the research centre will be set up at Palamu Tiger Reserve in Jharkhand.
2	1992	The booklet gives 1992 as the launch year of Project Elephant.
3	Haathi Mere Saathi	The booklet names the Haathi Mere Saathi campaign as the one that promotes coexistence between humans and elephants.
4	Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology	The booklet says the Ministry of Earth Sciences inaugurated the testbed with the Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology in Chennai.
5	Ministry of Earth Sciences	The booklet states that the Ministry of Earth Sciences inaugurated the testbed under Mission Mausam.
6	Jharkhand	The booklet states that Jharkhand is set to establish the dedicated research centre at Palamu Tiger Reserve.